

Nursery

ANSWER, MARKING & TEACHER ASSESSMENT GUIDE

AQ-001 to AQ-100

Purpose	Provide a consistent standard for marking knowledge, practical competence, investigation/data skills and mission-based problem solving.
Evidence sources	GrowMeal assessments, direct practical observation, journals, Garden Missions, Ingredient Lab, Farm-to-Food activities, Food Smart Challenges and passport evidence.
Core rubric	3 = Secure/Proficient; 2 = Developing; 1 = Beginning/Emerging; 0 = Not demonstrated.
Important rule	Do not award practical competence from a written answer alone. Practical scores require observed or otherwise verifiable performance evidence.
Moderation	Teachers should compare samples of learner evidence and discuss borderline scoring decisions before final level completion.

LEVEL ASSESSMENT WEIGHTING

Dimension	Weight	What is being judged
Knowledge	30%	Correctly identifies, recalls, classifies or explains the relevant garden/food concept using level-appropriate language.
Practical	30%	Performs the required procedure safely, in the correct sequence, with appropriate tool/material handling and sufficient independence.
Investigation/Data	20%	Collects or interprets evidence appropriately; records observations/measurements accurately; uses suitable comparison, calculation, graph or analysis for the level.
Mission Problem Solving	20%	Uses evidence to address the mission/problem, considers constraints, selects a defensible action and explains why it should work.

MASTER 0-3 PERFORMANCE RUBRIC

Knowledge

Score	Band	Descriptor
3	Secure / Proficient	Meets the knowledge criterion accurately and consistently with the independence expected at Nursery; evidence is sufficient and traceable.
2	Developing	Partly meets the criterion; the core idea/procedure is present but accuracy, completeness, independence or evidence quality still needs improvement.
1	Beginning / Emerging	Shows limited or inconsistent evidence; requires substantial prompting, correction or additional practice.
0	Not demonstrated	No usable evidence was demonstrated, submitted or observed for this criterion.

Practical

Score	Band	Descriptor
3	Secure / Proficient	Meets the practical criterion accurately and consistently with the independence expected at Nursery; evidence is sufficient and traceable.
2	Developing	Partly meets the criterion; the core idea/procedure is present but accuracy, completeness, independence or evidence quality still needs improvement.
1	Beginning / Emerging	Shows limited or inconsistent evidence; requires substantial prompting, correction or additional practice.
0	Not demonstrated	No usable evidence was demonstrated, submitted or observed for this criterion.

Investigation/Data

Score	Band	Descriptor
3	Secure / Proficient	Meets the investigation/data criterion accurately and consistently with the independence expected at Nursery; evidence is sufficient and traceable.
2	Developing	Partly meets the criterion; the core idea/procedure is present but accuracy, completeness, independence or evidence quality still needs improvement.
1	Beginning / Emerging	Shows limited or inconsistent evidence; requires substantial prompting, correction or additional practice.
0	Not demonstrated	No usable evidence was demonstrated, submitted or observed for this criterion.

Mission Problem Solving

Score	Band	Descriptor
3	Secure / Proficient	Meets the mission problem solving criterion accurately and consistently with the independence expected at Nursery; evidence is sufficient and traceable.
2	Developing	Partly meets the criterion; the core idea/procedure is present but accuracy, completeness, independence or evidence quality still needs improvement.
1	Beginning / Emerging	Shows limited or inconsistent evidence; requires substantial prompting, correction or additional practice.
0	Not demonstrated	No usable evidence was demonstrated, submitted or observed for this criterion.

ANSWER AND MARKING RULES

Closed knowledge items	Use the keyed response where an item has one correct answer. Do not award a mark for a contradictory response merely because it contains a correct word.
Open knowledge items	Accept scientifically or practically equivalent wording when the learner demonstrates the intended concept.
Nursery evidence	Oral answers, pointing, matching, drawing and teacher-observed performance may substitute for writing where appropriate.
Measurements	Require units where the task calls for them. Minor arithmetic slips may be separated from method quality when the intended reasoning is clear.
Graphs/tables	Judge labels, units, data placement, readability and whether the representation supports the conclusion.
Investigations	Reward a defensible method, traceable evidence and appropriate interpretation. Do not reward invented data.
Missions	Score the learner's reasoning and use of evidence, not only whether the final outcome happened to succeed.
Safety	A procedure that achieves the task by ignoring a critical safety requirement cannot receive full practical marks.

ACHIEVEMENT BANDS AND DECISION RULES

85-100	Advanced: consistently strong evidence across the weighted dimensions.
70-84	Secure: expected level competence is demonstrated with generally reliable evidence.
55-69	Developing: meaningful competence is present but important gaps remain.
40-54	Emerging: partial evidence; targeted teaching and reassessment are required.
Below 40	Requires targeted support before level completion is treated as secure.
Critical competence rule	A high total score should not conceal absence of essential safety or practical competence. Teachers should review dimension scores before certification.
Reassessment	After feedback and additional practice, reassess the specific competency rather than repeating unnecessary parts of the entire assessment.

MODERATION PROTOCOL

Step 1	Select samples from high, middle and low scoring work, plus borderline cases.
Step 2	Score independently against the same criterion/rubric.
Step 3	Compare judgments and identify the evidence causing disagreement.
Step 4	Agree the interpretation of the criterion and rescore affected work if necessary.
Step 5	Record the moderation decision so the same standard is used across classes/teachers.
Step 6	Use repeated scoring disagreements to improve future task wording, demonstrations or teacher guidance.

TEACHER SCORE RECORD

[illegible]

INDIVIDUAL FEEDBACK & REASSESSMENT RECORD

Learner	_____
Strongest evidence	_____
Competency requiring support	_____
Feedback given	_____
Practice / remediation	_____
Reassessment evidence	_____
New score / status	_____
Teacher / date	_____